me. The girl touches every single person she meets. She glows. In my memory, meeting Kirsty at the start of the afternoon is up there with scoring my goal at the end of it.

Eventually, Kirsty had to find her way off the field and I had to remind myself we had a soccer game on here that needed winning. You're never sure until you kick off but we were right to have been worried about Greece. They were really up for the match, despite having already missed out on qualification. I remember one or two of them having a go at us after challenges, although not speaking Greek, I haven't got a clue what they were actually saying. They played well and we just couldn't get started. The players were uneasy and the crowd picked up on that. The game felt flat, like we needed a goal just to get us going. The trouble was, after half an hour or so, I found myself thinking that I couldn't see us scoring one. Ten minutes later, disaster: Greece scored. It was a sloppy goal, too, and between then and half-time we didn't find anything like the rhythm we needed to get back into the game. From thinking we needed the win to be sure of our place at the World Cup, we were in a position where we had to start thinking that at least a draw would give us a chance. At half-time, Sven wasn't panicking.

'We need to lift the tempo. We're waiting for things to happen. We need to push on and be the team that's making things happen.'

The start of the second half was better, but not by much. Nobody said anything but I just got it in my head that I needed to go looking for the ball. I was angry. Angry with myself. Angry with the Greek players who were having digs at us. Angry about the situation we'd got ourselves in. It was hot and we looked tired. It's not right to rely on anybody else in that kind of situation. You have to try and do something about it yourself. It wasn't a case of thinking it was my responsibility or something I had to do as a skipper. It simply felt as if it was time to take risks. If I wasn't getting the ball in my position, I decided to try and get involved somewhere else. I remember Gary Neville shouting at me:

'You'll get caught. We've got to keep our shape or they'll break off us and score again.'

In almost any other game, Gary would have been right. But that afternoon against Greece, for once, I decided to take no notice of Gaz. I tried running at players and drew a couple of fouls around the penalty area. It was the kind of afternoon, though, when every free-kick was going high or wide however hard I tried. Nothing seemed to be going right for us, at least until about